

Introduction to Historical Scripts

A first look at six writing systems and how to read them.

This mini-course introduces six historical scripts. For each one you get the script, a sample word, its transliteration and a short note. It is a study introduction, not a full course.

1. Latin alphabet

S P Q R

Transliteration: *es-pe-ku-er*

Note: The ancestor of our alphabet; left to right, no diacritics in classical use.

2. Greek script

A B Γ Δ

Transliteration: *alpha, beta, gamma, delta*

Note: Source of many science and math symbols; left to right.

3. Hebrew (right to left)

שלום

Transliteration: *shalom — peace*

Note: Read right to left; vowel points (niqqud) are optional marks.

4. Arabic (right to left)

سَلَام

Transliteration: *salām — peace*

Note: Cursive and right to left; letters change shape by position.

5. Sanskrit (Devanagari)

नमस्ते

Transliteration: *namaste — greeting*

Note: Left to right; a horizontal line links letters across the top.

6. Old Norse (runes)

ᚱᚢᚾᚱᚱ

Transliteration: *f-u-th-a-r-k* — *Futhark*

Note: The Elder Futhark, named after the sounds of its first six runes.

Educational mini-course by Scriptorium. Samples are study introductions, not certified or critical editions.

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